

Milena Monova

Engineering & Technology Leader

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PROFILE

Engineering leader with 10+ years in software, currently engineering manager for a team of five at a UK food supply-chain technology company, reporting to the CEO. I started as a backend engineer (Node.js, Go, .NET) and have worked as a software architect, CTO and co-founder, and technical product manager.

I've led engineering teams since 2021, including 1:1s, performance reviews, career development, hiring and onboarding. I'm currently helping shape my company's AI strategy and supporting engineers through the move to AI-assisted development.

EXPERIENCE

Equilibrium Markets (Remote)

Food supply-chain technology company improving transparency and access to local food in UK public-sector procurement.

Mar 2024 - Present

Engineering Team Director

Jan 2026 - Present

- Line-manage a team of five: regular 1:1s, feedback, performance reviews and a career development plan for each person. Responsible for performance, resourcing and hiring.
- Created a 12-month upskilling programme combining individual career goals with company needs, including mentorship partners, targeted assignments, AI skills and learning budgets. It spread knowledge and ownership across the team, so the Tech Lead is no longer a single point of failure, alongside clear operational ownership, escalation routes and backup cover.
- Created and introduced a repeatable innovation process, including facilitated ideation and Prototype Days. Prototype hands-on alongside the team, coached them to turn ideas into one-day prototypes and transferred ownership of the process so it now runs independently.
- Facilitate the company's AI strategy discussions and support engineers through the transition to AI-assisted development.
- Built the team's onboarding structure (product, delivery process, testing practices, technical setup) and defined, wrote and screened for the team's first dedicated QA role.

Technical Product Manager

Mar 2025 - Jan 2026

- Took ownership of product and engineering planning when the team faced unclear requirements and a short deadline for user onboarding, bringing structure and predictability to delivery and meeting the deadline.
- Worked directly with the Supply Chain Manager to turn business and user requirements into functional specifications before development, reducing vague or unnecessary work reaching engineering.
- Introduced the team's first roadmap and a RICE-based prioritisation framework, and ran sprint planning, retrospectives, dailies and the wider Scrum process.

Integration Lead & Backend Consultant

Mar 2024 - Mar 2025

- Joined at 20% FTE to help build EM's supply-chain platform from scratch, taking ownership of its distributor integrations.
- Designed and built integrations with four food distributors (EDI, FTP, distributor-specific standards) and an API integration with Erudus, working directly with each distributor's technical team; all five went into production.

Collaberry (Remote)

Open-source dynamic compensation product for collaborative organisations, combining contribution assessment with transparent reward allocation.

Founder / Product & Technology Lead

Jan 2024 - Apr 2025

- Started Collaberry after a three-month RnDAO research fellowship on compensation in early-stage teams, resulting in a published research paper and a model for dynamic compensation based on peer-assessed contribution.
- Designed the TeamPoints methodology and initially ran it manually using Excel and Google Forms, testing monthly compensation cycles with 5–10 organisations for several months before building software.
- Secured ~\$38k in grant and public-goods funding, including an Arbitrum grant and Gitcoin funding, and used Collaberry's own dynamic compensation model to build a contributor team while extending the project's runway.
- Led product decisions and built the backend, smart contracts and infrastructure with contributors across frontend, design, product and marketing, then moved the pilot organisations onto the software; they kept using it after I left.

Aut Labs (Remote)

Venture-backed startup building role-based governance infrastructure for digital organisations. Started from a hackathon win and the Filecoin Launchpad Accelerator (Tachyon); nearly €2M in pre-seed funding.

CTO & Co-founder

Feb 2021 - Jun 2023

- Designed and built the core blockchain protocol, introducing on-chain identity, skills and roles as the foundation for role-based membership and governance.
- Hired and led an engineering team of four (frontend, full-stack and smart-contract developers) while remaining hands-on with protocol development; owned architecture, technical delivery and mentoring.
- Took the first developer product to market through hackathons including ETHGlobal, using integration bounties to test it with external developers, then led the pivot to a modular platform for building and managing digital organisations.
- Worked with ecosystem partners including Polygon and supported the technical side of fundraising, preparing technical investor materials and participating in investor calls.

Equilibrium Markets (Remote)

Food supply-chain technology company improving transparency and access to local food in UK public-sector procurement.

Software Architect

Jan 2020 - Jan 2021

- Worked on the architecture and modernisation of EM's legacy food supply-chain platform, improving its reliability and maintainability.

ScaleFocus (Sofia, Bulgaria)

Software engineering consultancy building products for international clients.

Software Engineer

May 2019 - Jan 2020

- Designed and built backend and distributed systems for a US healthcare product built from the ground up (Node.js, Go), owning the technical design of key parts

Centroida (Sofia, Bulgaria)

Software development company specialising in distributed systems and emerging technologies.

Software Engineer

Jun 2016 - May 2019

- Built backend and distributed systems across multiple products, supported junior engineers and took on growing responsibility for architecture and technical decisions.

Mathematics Teacher

Sofia

Independent

2016 - 2024

- Taught secondary-school mathematics, adapting my approach to students who struggled with traditional teaching.

EDUCATION

Sofia University

Bachelors

Computer Science

2014 - 2018

SKILLS

Engineering Management · People Management · 1:1s & Performance Reviews · Career Development · Hiring & Onboarding · AI Adoption · Technical Strategy · Software Architecture · Backend & Distributed Systems · Node.js · Go · .NET · APIs & Integrations · Product Discovery · Zero-to-One Product Development